Custom Tag Insights

PRD · Oura app · Indhu Natarajan · Product case study · Independent, not affiliated with Oura · Prototype · Walkthrough video

TL;DR. Members create their own tags to answer their own questions ("does my magnesium help?", "are office days harder on me?"). Oura's automatic insights (Discoveries) currently cover standard tags only; custom and repeating tags are excluded. Advisor only sees the last 7 days of tags, and only when asked. **Proposal:** analyse custom tags over 60 days and, when a clear pattern appears, show it as a card on the Today tab that opens into Advisor for follow-up questions.

1 Problem

Oura members who create custom tags rarely get anything back unless they go digging themselves, because Oura's automatic insights (Discoveries) exclude custom tags, and Advisor only looks at the last 7 days of tags and only when asked. This matters because these members question what they are paying for, and Oura's AI bet misses the most personal context members give it.

2 Who it's for

Segment	Definition	Why them
Primary: custom-tag creators	Active members on Gen3 or newer who have created at least one custom tag and used it on 5+ days	Highest logging effort, clearest "what do I get back?" moment
Not in scope	Standard-tag-only users, non-members, Gen2	Standard tags already feed Discoveries

3 Evidence

Source	What it shows
Oura support pages (checked Oct 2026)	Discovery Hub is "not available for custom tags or repeating tags". Advisor uses tags from the past 7 days. Check-ins are reminders set by the member; Advisor does not raise patterns on its own.
r/ouraring, 75 threads (~2,700 comments)	44 on-topic tag comments: **30 complaints**, 5 positive. A thread on logging custom tags for 4 months with no insight: 202 upvotes. Users build workarounds (ChatGPT connector thread: 332 upvotes).
Reddit follow-ups (my replies, Oct 2026)	3 members answered my questions: 2 who made custom tags, 1 who uses standard tags (quotes below).
Survey (n = 3 members, Finland; directional only)	3/3 created custom tags because "it wasn't in the list". 2/3 unsure what a Discovery card is. 2/3 learned "a little" or "not really". 2/3 used tools outside Oura. 2/3 considered not renewing (price).
Competitor: WHOOP Journal	Daily yes/no prompt; shows behaviour impact automatically after 5 "yes" and 5 "no" days within 90 days.

> *"In the past, custom tags didn't work with their insights, so I didn't see the point. It's possible they do now?"*
> r/ouraring member, Oct 2026

> *"Tagged everything religiously for the first 3 months and received zero insights."*
> r/ouraring member

> *"We can't really see a lot of information about the tags on any screen unless we ask from AI."*
> r/ouraring member (19 upvotes)

> *"This is something we have been hearing from members, and we have updates coming to make it easier to tag."*
> Oura Social Care Team on Reddit

Counter-evidence, kept honest. One survey respondent did learn something ("the effects of certain food and drinks for my readiness"), but only by asking Advisor *and* using ChatGPT/Claude. One heavy custom-tag user finds tags "super helpful" but says "nothing surprising has jumped out". Oura already finds patterns for standard tags ("Oura picked up a trend... on days I get headaches I sleep worse"). **So the insight is possible; it just doesn't reach custom tags unless the member goes digging.**

4 Why Oura should care

- **Membership value:** membership is ~20% of revenue and growing fast (+121% YoY). First-year retention is already strong (~85%), so this is about **year-2+ value**, not a retention crisis.
- **AI strategy:** Oura is moving from wellness to personalised, preventive health, with Advisor at the centre. Custom tags are members' own context, exactly what a personal advisor needs, and today it goes unused.
- **Not covered by Oura's announced work:** Oura says updates are coming to make it "easier to tag" (input). This PRD is about the **output**: getting something back from tags.

5 Goals and non-goals

Goals

- Custom-tag users get **personal patterns** from their own tags
- Patterns come to the member **proactively**, without digging
- Members can **go deeper** with Advisor in one tap

Non-goals

- Advisor's general answer quality, tone or memory
- Tag logging and input (Oura's announced work)
- Meals, standard-tag redesign, community comparison
- Push notifications (opt-in later, if at all)
- Medical claims; patterns are correlation, not cause

6 Solution: how it behaves

Key flow (built in the prototype)

1 · TAG
Member tags "Office day" on some days, not others, over several weeks

→

2 · DETECT
5+ days with and 5+ days without the tag in the last 60 days; clear difference vs own baseline

→

3 · CARD
Today tab card next morning: "Office days: your daytime stress is higher"

→

4 · ADVISOR
Tap opens Advisor with the pattern, a chart and how many days it's based on

→

5 · ACT
Ask a follow-up · 👍/👎 · "Not relevant for this tag"

Behaviour rules

Rule	Behaviour	Why
Who sees it	Active members, Gen3+, with at least one custom tag	Same access as Discoveries and Advisor
When it triggers	5+ days **with** the tag and 5+ days **without** it in the last 60 days, and a clear difference in one metric (sleep, HRV, resting HR, stress, readiness). Threshold set with data science.	Fair comparison; goes beyond Advisor's 7 days. Same 5 + 5 rule as WHOOP, but WHOOP asks yes/no daily, while this infers "without" from untagged days
Where it shows	A card in the Today tab card stack, below the daily highlight. Button: "✦ Dive in with Advisor" (the same button already used on My Health) opens Advisor with the pattern loaded	The highlight is for today's urgent signals; a 60-day pattern isn't urgent. Reuses existing patterns; no push needed
What it says	Plain language, direction and size, days compared, "correlation, not cause". Can confirm a hunch ("you guessed right").	Builds trust; on Reddit, a member said Advisor "told me my HRV was improving when it had dropped 10 points… trust broken"
Frequency	Max 1 pattern card per week; a dismissed card never repeats	Avoid alert fatigue (stress alerts are a common complaint)
Not enough data yet	In the tag's details: "To find a pattern, Oura compares days with and without this tag. With: 20 ✓ · Without: 2 of 5" (or "With: 3 of 5 · Without: 19 ✓" for a rarely used tag)	Explains the wait; nudges logging both kinds of days
Why 60 days	Start at 60, tune with data	7 days is too short for 5 + 5; 30 is tight for a 2–3×/week tag; 90 (WHOOP) delays the first insight
Privacy	Tag text is analysed only for this member; never shared or compared	Custom tags can be sensitive

7 Requirements

Priority	Requirement
P0	Analyse custom tags over a 60-day window using the 5-with / 5-without rule, for one metric at a time
P0	“From your own tags” card in the Today tab card stack, max 1 per week
P0	Card opens Advisor with the pattern, a chart, days compared, and 2–3 suggested follow-up questions
P0	👍/👎 on each card; “Not relevant for this tag” stops future cards for that tag
P1	Progress hint in tag details (“With: 20 ✓ · Without: 2 of 5”)
P1	Repeating tags: count days the member removed the repeat as “without” days; if still too few, a one-tap morning check “Did you do X yesterday?” for that tag only (like WHOOP’s daily yes/no)
P1	“See in Trends” link from the Advisor answer
P2	Opt-in push notification for new patterns

8 How to know it worked

Type	Metric	Why · starting target (hypothesis)
Key	**Useful-pattern rate:** % of eligible custom-tag members who mark at least one pattern 👍 within 60 days	Measures the payback itself, not just views · **30%**: about half open the card × about 60% find it useful (60% of Advisor beta testers said it helped them understand their metrics)
Secondary	Follow-up rate: % of opened cards that lead to an Advisor question	Shows members want to go deeper · 25%: one step more than reading; about half of those who find it useful, rounded down
Secondary	Custom-tag continuation: % still tagging after 8 weeks, compared with a control group (similar members who don’t get the feature)	Effort pays back, so logging continues · +10 percentage points (e.g. 50% vs 40%). 8 weeks ≈ the 60-day window, so most members have had a chance to get a pattern
Guardrail	👎 **+ “Not relevant” rate** per card shown	Wrong or useless patterns break trust · stay **below 20%** (fewer than 1 in 5 cards): 83% of Advisor beta testers found answers reliable, so the card should be at least as trusted
Lagging	Renewal rate of custom-tag members vs control	The business outcome; read after 12 months

9 Risks and assumptions

Assumption	If wrong	Likelihood it’s wrong / Impact on success	Response · signal to watch
Members want patterns, not just a diary	Cards are ignored; low 👍	Med / High	Start as a beta in Oura Labs; if 👍 < 15%, keep it opt-in · *useful-pattern rate*
Patterns are reliable despite untagged days being unclear	Wrong patterns, trust breaks	Med / High	5/5 minimum, plain confidence wording, progress hint · 👎 *rate*
Enough members create custom tags	Small reach, low impact	Unknown / Med	Check Oura data first; if few, fold into Discovery Hub instead (fallback) · *% of taggers with custom tags*
No overlap with Oura’s announced tagging updates	Duplicate work	Low / Med	Position as the output layer on top of better input · *roadmap check*

No-engineering step first (manual pattern test): ask ~10 custom-tag members to export their data, find their patterns by hand, send each person their result and ask “was this useful?”. This tests K1 (do members want patterns?) before anything is built.

When I would drop this direction (kill criteria)

- **K1:** most custom-tag users use tags only as a diary and don’t want patterns
- **K2:** Advisor or Discoveries already answer their questions well
- **K3:** fewer than ~1 in 5 taggers use custom tags

10 Open questions

- How many members create custom tags, and how many would reach 5/5 days in 60 days? (Oura internal data)
- What size of difference is “clear enough” per metric? (data science)
- Should the member map a custom tag to a category (e.g. “supplement”) to improve analysis?
- How to handle repeating daily tags that never have “without” days? (Option: the one-tap morning check in P1)

11 Next steps

#	Step	Outcome
1	Size the segment with Oura data (K3)	Go / fall back to Discovery Hub
2	Usability test the prototype with 5 custom-tag users	Is the card clear and trusted?
3	Manual pattern test + survey 30+ custom-tag members (K1, K2)	Confirm demand for patterns
4	Dogfood with Oura employees who use custom tags	Catch confusing wording and wrong patterns
5	Beta in Oura Labs (opt-in testers), then an A/B test (B = control group without the feature)	Set real baselines; read key, secondary and guardrail metrics

12 Research limits

- **Small survey:** 3 valid member responses, all in Finland. Used as directional quotes only, no percentages claimed.
- **Reddit skews to engaged, US-based power users**, the people most likely to tag, and most likely to complain.
- **I don’t own an Oura ring.** The “before” state comes from Oura’s support pages, blog posts and user screenshots.

Sources: Oura Support — Using Tags; Discovery Hub; Oura Advisor; How to Use Trends (Oct 2026). Oura Blog — Discoveries; Custom & smart tags; Advisor in Action. WHOOP — The WHOOP Journal. Oura S-1 analyses (Mostly Metrics, Subscription Insider, Saxo). r/ouraring threads (75 saved, Sep–Oct 2026). Member survey (Oct 2026, n = 5, 3 valid).